

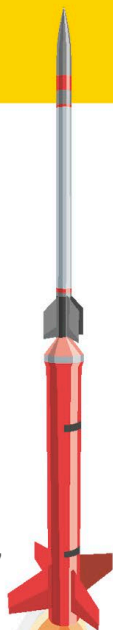
November

21

1963

## Rocket launch

India's first rocket blasted off from the Thumba Equatorial Rocket Launch Station (TERLS). Supplied by NASA, the *Nike-Apache* sounding rocket carried out in-flight experiments, marking the start of the country's space programme.



2019

## Shatterproof shocker

Tesla chief executive Elon Musk launched the car company's electric pick-up truck, Cybertruck, at a special event in Los Angeles, USA. However, his demonstration did not go to plan when the vehicle's shatterproof windows smashed on stage.

## Also on this day

**1783** The first untethered hot-air balloon with people on board took off from Paris, France, and flew 8 km (5 miles) before landing safely.

**2017** Cheers greeted the reading aloud of Robert Mugabe's resignation letter in the Zimbabwean parliament after his controversial 37 years as the country's leader.

1843

## Vulcanized rubber

British engineer Thomas Hancock patented his invention of tough vulcanized rubber, made by placing natural rubber in molten sulphur. It transformed the automobile industry as tyres made of vulcanized rubber could withstand extreme heat and cold, making them last longer.



## Born this day

**1965 Björk**, Icelandic singer and songwriter. She is known for her innovative musical style, which blends influences from many genres.

**1987 Eesha Karavade**, Indian chess player. She made her mark on the world stage by winning the titles of International Master and Woman Grandmaster.